

Brian W. Payne

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Engineering Leadership • Product & Platform Engineering • Engineering Effectiveness • AI & Agentic Development • Technology Strategy • Organizational Leadership

Engineering and technology leader experienced in building high-performing organizations and customer-facing digital products by aligning engineering, product, technology, and business priorities. Experience spans engineering effectiveness, product and platform development, organizational design, operational reliability, and AI-enabled transformation, with current hands-on work applying agentic development workflows to build and deploy production software.

EXPERIENCE

Sulcata Partners

New York, NY / Yardley, PA

Consulting firm focused on operations, technology, customer experience, and organizational improvement.

Operations & Technology Consultant

2025 - present

Advise startups, professional sports organizations, and retail businesses on technology strategy, engineering and product operations, AI adoption and agentic development, customer experience, and organizational effectiveness.

- Developed product strategy, technology roadmap, staffing model, and 18-month operating plan for an early-stage technology company, aligning product, engineering, and business priorities to support fundraising and growth.
- Designed data, analytics, scouting, and AI/RAG capabilities supporting baseball operations and executive decision-making for professional baseball organizations.
- Advised organizations on technology and operating-model decisions spanning platform capabilities, data, AI, organizational structure, and cross-functional execution.
- Built and deployed production business applications and integrations using agentic software-development workflows, working with ChatGPT/Codex, Git/GitHub, APIs, and cloud deployment platforms to rapidly translate business requirements into working software.

Chief

New York, NY

Private membership network and digital platform serving senior women executives.

Senior Director of Engineering

2023 - 2024

Led a product engineering organization of 40+ engineers, managers, and technical staff spanning customer-facing applications, platform systems, and engineering operations during a period of significant organizational transformation. Partnered with executive leadership to simplify the operating model, strengthen cross-functional execution, and deliver more with fewer resources while maintaining member experience and platform reliability.

- **Redesigned the engineering operating model** by reorganizing 40+ engineers into cross-functional product teams, improving ownership, collaboration, and delivery consistency across engineering, product, and business.
- **Entrusted with expanded organizational leadership** following an executive transition, providing continuity across Engineering while also overseeing Product through multiple organizational restructurings.
- **Inherited and managed a ~\$15M departmental budget**, reducing technology and vendor spend by approximately 20–30% through vendor consolidation, application rationalization, licensing optimization, and tighter cost controls.
- **Improved engineering effectiveness** by introducing modern development workflows, AI-assisted practices, and stronger operational visibility, enabling teams to deliver more consistently with significantly reduced resources.

Pro Football Focus

Cincinnati, OH / NYC, NY

Sports analytics and digital products company serving professional football teams, media, and consumers.

VP Engineering of Consumer Products

2021 - 2022

Recruited by the CEO to establish the company's first Consumer Engineering organization spanning web, mobile, backend, and data capabilities, helping transform a sports analytics business into a consumer product company.

- Built and led the company's first Consumer Engineering organization responsible for new digital consumer experiences.
- Introduced customer discovery, MVP development, experimentation, and cross-functional Product-Engineering collaboration to establish a modern consumer product operating model.
- Established the organizational foundation for consumer product development before executive leadership changes redirected company priorities.

Major League Baseball

New York, NY

Professional sports league operating Major League Baseball's digital products, media, streaming, ticketing, and fan experiences.

Director of Engineering (Digital Platforms & Experimentation)

2018 – 2021

Led engineering for shared digital platform capabilities supporting MLB's consumer products, with responsibility spanning experimentation, customer measurement, video, and platform standardization. Partnered across Product, Engineering, Analytics, and Design to improve customer learning and accelerate digital product development.

- **Led development** and adoption of a shared experimentation and customer-measurement platform across MLB's digital products, replacing fragmented approaches with standardized capabilities that reduced duplicate engineering effort and enabled teams to test and learn more consistently.
- **Standardized video player capabilities** across MLB digital experiences, improving consistency and reducing video startup latency by approximately 50%.
- Partnered across Product, Engineering, Analytics, and Design to establish **experimentation** and customer-learning practices that strengthened iterative product development.

Priceline

New York, NY

Leading online travel platform for hotels, flights, rental cars, and vacation packages.

Director of Engineering

2015 – 2018

Hired as Priceline's first Director of Engineering to help scale a rapidly growing product engineering organization spanning web and mobile experiences. Led organizational redesign, product-aligned engineering teams, and stronger collaboration across Engineering, Product, Design, and User Research.

- Reorganized engineering into cross-functional, product-aligned teams while introducing Agile operating models and delivery practices that improved ownership, collaboration, and execution.
- Led engineering for customer-facing web and mobile experiences, partnering with Product and Design on initiatives that contributed to approximately 2% year-over-year conversion improvement for the Hotels business.
- Led Priceline's User Research function, including team operations, prioritization, and budget, integrating customer research, experimentation, and feedback into Product and Engineering decision-making.

EARLY CAREER

eBay Marketplace, San Jose, CA — Engineering Manager, Buyer Experience - Built and led engineering teams within eBay's Buyer Experience organization, establishing rapid-prototyping capabilities and strengthening collaboration across Design, Research, Product, and Engineering. **2011 - 2015**

GSI Commerce, King of Prussia, PA — Technical Developer Lead - Progressed from developer to team lead, ultimately leading engineering delivery for major ecommerce clients including Ralph Lauren. **2002 - 2010**

EXECUTIVE CAPABILITIES

Engineering Organizations & Operating Models • Product & Platform Engineering • Engineering Effectiveness & Reliability • AI Enablement & Agentic Engineering • Customer Experience & Digital Product • Executive & Cross-Functional Leadership

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Agentic Software Development • AI-Assisted Engineering • ChatGPT / Codex • AI/RAG Applications • Git / GitHub • JavaScript / TypeScript • Java • Kafka • Event-driven Architecture • React • Node.js • APIs & Distributed Systems • Cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure) • Vercel • DevOps & CI/CD • GraphQL • Experimentation Platforms • Operational Reliability

EDUCATION

Temple University, Accounting

Philadelphia, PA

Chubb Institute, Software Development

Springfield, PA

INTERESTS

Cycling & Bike Touring • Guitar • Genealogy